

PassportSahayak AI

Knowledge Base Document

Passport Types, Categories & Eligibility

Fresh Application, Renewal, Tatkal, Reissue & Special Categories

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Category	Passport Application
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1. Purpose & Scope

This document defines all passport categories available under the Passport Seva Programme, eligibility criteria for each application type, validity periods, booklet options, and ECR/ECNR classification rules. It serves as the primary reference for both citizen applicants and PSK/RPO counter officials.

1.1 Policy Objectives

- Provide clear eligibility rules for all passport application types
- Define validity periods, booklet size options, and ECR/ECNR classifications
- Enable PSK officials to verify applicant category at the counter
- Ensure compliance with the Passports Act 1967 and MEA/CPV Division circulars

1.2 Applicability

Actor	Covered Under This Document	Exceptions
Applicant (Citizen)	All sections — category selection through Tatkal	Minor-specific rules in KB-PASS-002
PSK Counter Official	Category verification, ECR/ECNR check, Tatkal eligibility	SLA/queue in KB-PASS-006
RPO Back-Office	Re-issue rules, special category review	Appeal procedures in KB-PASS-005

2. Passport Types

2.1 Ordinary Passport (Type P)

The standard travel document issued to Indian citizens for international travel.

Parameter	Detail
Validity — Adult (18+)	10 years from date of issue
Validity — Minor (below 18)	5 years or until the minor turns 18, whichever is earlier
Booklet — Standard	36 pages (recommended for infrequent travellers)
Booklet — Jumbo	60 pages (recommended for frequent travellers or multi-visa holders)
Colour	Navy blue cover
Governing Law	Passports Act 1967, Passport Rules 1980
Issuing Authority	Regional Passport Office (RPO) via Passport Seva Kendra (PSK)

2.2 Official Passport (Type S)

Issued to government officials travelling abroad on official duty. Routed through the concerned Ministry/Department — not processed at PSK.

NOTE: Official Passport queries must be routed to the Ministry's Liaison Office. PSK/RPO counters do not process Official Passport applications.

2.3 Diplomatic Passport (Type D)

Issued exclusively to diplomats and high-ranking government officers as notified by the MEA. Not processed at PSK centres.

3. Application Categories

3.1 Fresh Application

A fresh passport application is made by an Indian citizen who has never held a passport, or whose previous passport was issued before January 1, 1990.

Parameter	Rule / Detail
Eligibility	Indian citizen, no existing valid passport (or pre-1990 passport)
Minor (below 18)	Applied by parent/guardian; both parents' consent required (Annexure C/H for single parent)
Documentation	Proof of birth, identity, address — see KB-PASS-002 for complete checklist
Processing — Normal	30 working days (post-PV) or 7 working days (pre-PV / PV-exempt)
Processing — Tatkal	3 working days (see Section 5 for Tatkal eligibility)
Police Verification	Pre-PV or post-PV depending on category — see KB-PASS-003
Application Channel	Passport Seva Portal (passportindia.gov.in) → appointment → PSK visit

3.2 Renewal / Re-issue Application

A renewal (re-issue) application is made when the existing passport is valid, near expiry, or expired.

Scenario	Category	Key Rule
Passport expired within 3 years	Re-issue	Previous passport surrendered; no fresh application needed
Passport expired more than 3 years ago	Fresh Application	Treated as fresh; fresh-application PV rules apply
Passport valid but pages exhausted	Re-issue (Additional Booklet)	Previous passport surrendered at counter
Name/address change required	Re-issue	Supporting documents for the change are required
Damaged / mutilated passport	Re-issue	FIR not required unless suspected theft
Validity extension	Not applicable	Indian passports cannot be extended; re-issue only

3.3 Lost Passport Re-issue

Parameter	Rule / Detail
FIR Requirement	Mandatory — FIR from jurisdictional police station before applying
Affidavit	Notarised affidavit explaining circumstances of loss required
Additional Fee	Higher fee applicable (see Section 4.2)
PV Classification	Pre-PV mandatory — passport dispatched only after PV clearance
Repeated Loss	Third or subsequent lost passport triggers EscalationTool referral to RPO
Cancellation	Lost passport is blacklisted in MEA database; cannot be reactivated

3.4 Change of Personal Particulars

Change Type	Documents Required	PV Required?
Name change (marriage)	Marriage certificate + Gazette notification	Post-PV
Name change (legal/deed poll)	Gazette notification + court order	Post-PV
Address change	New address proof (Aadhaar/utility bill)	Pre-PV at new address

Change Type	Documents Required	PV Required?
Spouse name inclusion/removal	Marriage certificate / divorce decree	Post-PV
ECR to ECNR upgrade	Educational qualification certificate	No PV required
Date of birth correction	Birth certificate + affidavit + 2 supporting docs	Pre-PV

4. Validity & Fee Schedule

4.1 Validity Periods

Applicant Category	Validity
Adults (18 years and above)	10 years from date of issue
Minors below 5 years	5 years or until age 18, whichever is earlier
Minors aged 5–17 years	5 years or until age 18, whichever is earlier
Emergency Certificate (EC)	Single journey only; not a substitute for a regular passport

4.2 Fee Schedule (Effective April 2024)

All fees are as per MEA/CPV Division notification. Fees are non-refundable once the appointment is confirmed.

Application Type	36-Page	60-Page	Tatkal Surcharge
Fresh — Normal	Rs.1,500	Rs.2,000	N/A
Re-issue — Normal	Rs.1,500	Rs.2,000	N/A
Fresh / Re-issue — Tatkal	Rs.3,500	Rs.4,000	Rs.2,000 included
Lost Passport Re-issue	Rs.3,000	Rs.3,500	+ Rs.2,000 if Tatkal
Minor (below 18) — Normal	Rs.1,000	N/A	N/A
Minor — Tatkal	Rs.3,000	N/A	Rs.2,000 included

Note: Payment via Passport Seva Portal at booking: debit/credit card, UPI, net banking. Cash not accepted at PSK.

5. Tatkal Scheme

The Tatkal scheme enables expedited passport issuance within 3 working days for applicants with genuine urgency.

5.1 Tatkal Eligibility Criteria

- Medical emergency requiring immediate travel abroad
- Death of a close relative abroad requiring immediate travel
- Employment/work visa where travel date is within 30 days
- Education — visa deadline or admission date within 30 days
- Court/legal summons abroad requiring immediate travel
- Expiry of existing passport with confirmed travel within 30 days
- Sports/cultural event representing India

IMPORTANT: Tatkal eligibility is verified at the PSK counter. Supporting documentation is mandatory. If the reason cannot be verified, the application is downgraded to Normal scheme without fee refund.

5.2 Tatkal Processing Rules

Parameter	Rule / Detail
Processing Time	3 working days from PSK visit date
Tatkal Surcharge	Rs.2,000 in addition to standard fee (non-refundable)
Police Verification	Post-PV: passport dispatched first; PV completed within 30 days of issue
Slot Availability	Limited — typically 10–15% of total daily slots at each PSK
Live Slot Check	AppointmentBookingTool retrieves real-time Tatkal slot availability by PSK and date
Downgrade Rule	If document verification fails at counter, downgraded to Normal; surcharge not refunded
Minors on Tatkal	Applicable for minors with same eligibility criteria; both parents' consent required

6. ECR / ECNR Classification

ECR (Emigration Check Required) and ECNR (Emigration Check Not Required) determine whether an Indian passport holder needs emigration clearance before travelling to notified countries for employment.

6.1 ECR-Designated Countries (18 Countries)

UAE, Saudi Arabia, Qatar, Kuwait, Oman, Bahrain, Malaysia, Indonesia, Libya, Jordan, Yemen, Sudan, Brunei, Afghanistan, Iraq, Syria, Thailand, Lebanon. Emigration clearance from the Protector of Emigrants is required for ECR holders seeking employment in these countries.

6.2 ECR vs ECNR Eligibility

Criterion	ECR Passport Holder	ECNR Passport Holder
Educational Qualification	Below matriculation (10th standard)	Matriculate (10th pass) and above
Government Employees	N/A	All serving/retired central and state government employees
Income Tax Payees	N/A	ITR filed for at least 3 consecutive years
Diplomatic/Official Passport	N/A	ECNR by default
Professional Certificate Holders	N/A	Engineers, doctors, lawyers, CAs, MBAs, architects

Note: ECNR status is permanent once granted. ECR applicants qualifying for ECNR must apply for re-issue with educational certificate.

7. Statutory Compliance Reference

Applicable Law / Notification	Provision	Alignment
Passports Act 1967	Governs issue, refusal, revocation of passports	Fully compliant
Passport Rules 1980	Procedural rules for all passport categories	Fully compliant
MEA CPV Division Circular (2024)	Fee schedule effective April 2024	Fees updated per circular
Emigration Act 1983	ECR/ECNR classification and emigration clearance	Fully compliant
RTI Act 2005	Applicants may seek status info via RTI	Status via ApplicationStatusTool

8. Document Control

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